

Middle East Daily Brief

July 7, 2026

Executive summary

13 stories from 8 outlets (6 perspectives) over the reporting window. Leading the day: Huge crowds fill Tehran for main day of Khamenei's funeral as new supreme leader stays hidden.

Top stories

1. **Huge crowds fill Tehran for main day of Khamenei's funeral as new supreme leader stays hidden** *Al Jazeera, Arab News, BBC, CNN, Middle East Eye, NBC News, NPR, PBS, The Jerusalem Post* · corroborated by 9 outlets The main day of Ayatollah Ali Khamenei's state funeral drew the week's largest crowds as a truck bore the coffins of the slain supreme leader and four family members along a 10km route from Imam Hossein Square to Azadi Square in Tehran... <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/7/6/huge-crowd-joins-funeral-procession-for-irans-supreme-leader-khamenei>
2. **Macron arrives in Damascus, first Western head of state to visit Syria since Assad's fall** *The National, Cyprus Mail, SANA, The Times of Israel, Washington Post* · corroborated by 5 outlets Emmanuel Macron landed in Damascus, becoming the first Western head of state to visit Syria since the fall of Bashar al-Assad. He held talks with President Ahmed al-Sharaa and pledged France's support 'for a sovereign Syria, united in its... <https://www.thenationalnews.com/news/mena/2026/07/06/macron-arrives-in-damascus-on-historic-syria-trip/>
3. **Israeli strike on car in south Lebanon kills 4, including a school principal** *Al Jazeera, Asharq Al-Awsat, BBC, CBC, The Times of Israel* · corroborated by 5 outlets An Israeli airstrike on a vehicle in southern Lebanon killed four people, Lebanon's health ministry said, in one of the deadliest attacks since the June ceasefire. The victims were named as school principal Esperanza Ghandour, her mother,... <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/7/6/israeli-attack-on-vehicle-in-lebanon-kills-at-least-four>
4. **Trump says Iran offered concessions in nuclear talks but they are 'not final'** *The Times of Israel, Al Arabiya, Al Jazeera* · corroborated by 3 outlets President Trump said Iran had offered concessions in nuclear talks but cautioned the proposals were not final, telling reporters in the Oval Office, 'We've gotten concessions, now they have to hold to those concessions.' The comments came... <https://www.timesofisrael.com/liveblog-july-6-2026/>
5. **Hamas announces dissolution of its Gaza government in nod to Trump plan** *Middle East Eye, Al Jazeera, Middle East Monitor* · corroborated by 3 outlets Hamas said it is dissolving the administrative body that has governed the Gaza Strip for nearly two decades, a step analysts described as a concession to President Trump's postwar plan and its demand that the group cede governance. Under... <https://www.middleeasteye.net/news/hamas-decision-dissolve-gaza-government-a-nod-trump-expert-says>
6. **US-Iran negotiations to resume July 11 after funeral; sanctions and frozen funds on agenda** *Al Arabiya, Al Jazeera, The Times of Israel* · corroborated by 3 outlets US-Iran negotiations are set to resume on July 11 after the days-long funeral for Ali Khamenei, according to Al Arabiya,

with the agenda expected to cover sanctions relief, Iran's frozen funds and the unresolved nuclear file. The talks... <https://english.alarabiya.net/News/middle-east>

By theme

Israel – Gaza & the Palestinians

- **Hamas announces dissolution of its Gaza government in nod to Trump plan** – Middle East Eye, Al Jazeera, Middle East Monitor <https://www.middleeasteye.net/news/hamas-decision-dissolve-gaza-government-a-nod-trump-expert-says>
- **Israeli attacks kill at least 6 in Gaza as ceasefire violations continue** – Al Jazeera, Middle East Monitor <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/7/6/israeli-attacks-on-gaza-kill-at-least-6-as-ceasefire-violations-continue>
- **Netanyahu says Gaza reconstruction depends on Hamas disarmament** – Middle East Monitor, Middle East Eye <https://www.middleeastmonitor.com/20260706-netanyahu-says-gaza-reconstruction-depends-on-hamas-disarmament/>

Iran & the US

- **Huge crowds fill Tehran for main day of Khamenei's funeral as new supreme leader stays hidden** – Al Jazeera, Arab News, BBC, CNN, Middle East Eye, NBC News, NPR, PBS, The Jerusalem Post <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/7/6/huge-crowd-joins-funeral-procession-for-irans-supreme-leader-khamenei>
- **Trump says Iran offered concessions in nuclear talks but they are 'not final'** – The Times of Israel, Al Arabiya, Al Jazeera <https://www.timesofisrael.com/liveblog-july-6-2026/>
- **US-Iran negotiations to resume July 11 after funeral; sanctions and frozen funds on agenda** – Al Arabiya, Al Jazeera, The Times of Israel <https://english.alarabiya.net/News/middle-east>
- **Ahmadinejad and Kataib Hezbollah figures attend Khamenei funeral as Iran vows revenge** – The Jerusalem Post, Al Jazeera <https://www.jpost.com/middle-east/iran-news/article-901537>
- **Iran's 'funeral diplomacy': Quran verses and seating sent a message to Saudi Arabia** – Middle East Eye <https://www.middleeasteye.net/news/irans-funeral-diplomacy-quran-verses-ranked-allies-rivals-and-message-saudi-arabia>

Lebanon & Hezbollah

- **Israeli strike on car in south Lebanon kills 4, including a school principal** – Al Jazeera, Asharq Al-Awsat, BBC, CBC, The Times of Israel <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/7/6/israeli-attack-on-vehicle-in-lebanon-kills-at-least-four>

Syria & Iraq

- **Macron arrives in Damascus, first Western head of state to visit Syria since Assad's fall** – The National, Cyprus Mail, SANA, The Times of Israel, Washington Post <https://www.thenationalnews.com/news/mena/2026/07/06/macron-arrives-in-damascus-on-historic-syria-trip/>

Gulf & Arabian Peninsula

- **Cargo ship attacked off Yemen's Hodeidah as Houthis kill 16 government troops** — CBS News
<https://www.cbsnews.com/news/yemen-houthi-rebels-red-sea-attack-cargo-ship/>

Israel – politics & society

- **US to press Israel to curb settler and army violence in West Bank, Israeli media report** — Middle East Monitor, The Times of Israel <https://www.middleeastmonitor.com/20260706-us-to-urge-israel-to-curb-violence-against-palestinians-in-west-bank-israeli-media/>
- **Knesset advances Oct 7 inquiry bill 59-0 as opposition boycotts vote** — The Times of Israel
<https://www.timesofisrael.com/liveblog-july-6-2026/>

Perspective balance

Perspective	Stories
Qatari	3
Israeli	3
independent	2
pro-Palestinian	2
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Saudi	1

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